Met Office Hadley Centre observations datasets: HadUKP

> Home >

HadUKP - UK regional precipitation series

HadUKP is a series of datasets of UK regional precipitation, which incorporates the long-running **England & Wales Precipitation (EWP)** series beginning in 1766, the longest instrumental series of this kind in the world. The map (below) shows the regions that are available.

The monthly EWP series goes back to 1766, whereas the monthly series for the sub-regions of England and Wales begin in 1873. The monthly series for Scotland (and sub-regions) and Northern Ireland begin in 1931. All the daily series begin in 1931.

Brief description of the data

HadUKP incorporates a selection of long-running rainfall stations to provide a homogeneity-adjusted series of areally averaged precipitation. The England and Wales (HadEWP) precipitation totals are based on daily weighted totals from a network of stations within each of five England and Wales regions. A full quality control is performed on the 5th of each subsequent month, allowing data from the most recent six months to be updated.



DOWNLOAD DATA >>

Data are available from the download page without charge, but please read the terms and conditions. HadUKP datasets are freely available for use under Open Government License. However, please acknowledge the source if the data are used in any report or product.

Commercial and media enquiries

You can access the Met Office Customer Centre, any time of the day or night, by phone, fax or e-mail. Trained staff will help you find the information or products that are right for you.
Contact the Met Office Customer Centre

References

When using this dataset in reports, publications or presentations, please use the following citation:
Alexander, L.V. and Jones, P.D. (2001) Updated precipitation series for the U.K. and discussion of recent extremes, Atmospheric Science Letters doi:10.1006/asle.2001.0025.

Other information

- View HadUKP diagnostics
- During 2011, all daily and monthly HadUKP values since the start of 2006 were re-calculated using a more representative, evenly-spread selection of stations. This was necessary because some stations had closed and also some new ones were available. Thus some values have altered, but overall the figures are more accurate. We have ensured that the series remain homogeneous. The process of selecting the updated set of stations is described in this Climate Memorandum.
- HadUKP is produced using an operational system which relies on a number of components. Daily support is not available for this system, therefore the data may occasionally be found not to be right up-to-date. If you experience any problems or want to request a more reliable service please contact us.
- Please note that an alternative England and Wales Rainfall series is produced at the Met Office by the National Climate Information Centre. It is calculated from a gridded dataset produced using all available stations back to 1910, but it is not available for daily timescales and is not adjusted for temporal homogeneity. HadUKP is based upon a smaller network of representative stations and is adjusted for temporal homogeneity as well as being available on daily timescales back to 1931.

Dataset produced in collaboration with:

Met Office

CRU

Maintained by: National Climate Information Centre
Last updated: 19/05/2026
Hosted by: Met Office Hadley Centre for Climate Change

© Crown Copyright